



Domain, Email and Launch Setup

Everything needed to put the website on riwaaya.in, get info@riwaaya.in working, and have Google find it. Written to be followed top to bottom.

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What you need open, and how long this takes YOU

About an hour in total, most of it waiting. None of it is difficult — it is mostly copying values from one screen into another.

- ☐ **The registrar login** — wherever Bhumi bought riwaaya.in (GoDaddy, BigRock, Hostinger, Namecheap and so on). This is the one thing nobody else can do for you. If she bought it and you do not have the login, get that first; everything here stops without it.
- ☐ **The Vercel dashboard** — where the website is hosted, at vercel.com.
- ☐ **A decision on email** — free or paid. Step 3 lays out both; it takes two minutes to decide and it is the only real choice in this document.
- ☐ **A card**, only if you pick the paid email option.

WHY I CANNOT DO THIS PART FOR YOU

Everything else on this project I can do from the code. This part I cannot: it needs a login to an account that belongs to Bhumi, and in one case a payment. That is exactly as it should be — the domain and the mailbox are hers, and they should stay in her name rather than mine or yours.

STEP 1

Add the domain to Vercel YOU

Do this before touching DNS. Vercel will then print the exact records you need, which is safer than copying them out of this document.

- ☐ Open `vercel.com` → the Riwaaya project → **Settings** → **Domains**.
- ☐ Type `riwaaya.in` and press Add.
- ☐ When it offers to add `www.riwaaya.in` as well, say yes. Vercel will redirect one to the other automatically.
- ☐ It will now show you a red or amber “Invalid Configuration” notice, with the DNS records it wants. **Leave this screen open** — you need the values in the next step.

READ THIS BEFORE STEP 2

Vercel may offer to take over the domain’s nameservers entirely. **Decline that.** If Vercel runs the DNS, the email records have to be added there too, and you end up managing one domain in two places. Keep DNS at the registrar and add records by hand — that way the website and the mailbox live side by side in one screen.

DONE WHEN the domain is listed in Vercel, even though it still says the configuration is invalid. That notice clears in Step 2.

Point the domain at the website YOU

Two records at the registrar. This is the step that makes riwaaya.in show the website instead of a parking page.

- ☐ Log in at the registrar and find the DNS settings. It is usually called **DNS Management**, **Manage DNS**, or **Advanced DNS**.
- ☐ Delete any existing **A** record on **@** and any **CNAME** on **www**. Registrars ship a parking page by default and it will fight you otherwise.
- ☐ Add these two records:

RECORD 1 — the website itself

Type	A
Name	@ (some registrars want the word “blank” or riwaaya.in)
Value	76.76.21.21
TTL	Automatic, or 3600

RECORD 2 — the www version

Type	CNAME
Name	www
Value	cname.vercel-dns.com
TTL	Automatic, or 3600

USE VERCEL'S NUMBERS, NOT MINE

The values above are what Vercel shows in almost every case, and they are here so you know what you are looking at. But if the Domains screen from Step 1 shows anything different, **that screen wins** — Vercel occasionally issues a different address for a project, and it is the one that knows.

Now go back to the Vercel Domains screen and refresh. It usually turns green within a few minutes, though DNS can take up to a few hours to reach everyone.

DONE WHEN Vercel shows **Valid Configuration** and typing riwaaya.in into a browser loads the website.

STEP 3

Choose an email provider YOU

The domain does not come with email. Something has to run the mailbox, and there are two sensible options. This is the only genuine decision in this document.

Google Workspace RECOMMENDED

Around ₹150 per person per month — check current pricing, it changes.

- It is real Gmail. It opens in the Gmail app already on her phone, alongside her personal account.
- Nothing new to learn, which for a business mailbox is worth more than the fee.
- 30 GB, Drive, Calendar and Meet included.
- Works with any mail app, now and later.

Zoho Mail — free plan

Free, permanently — up to 5 mailboxes on one domain.

- Genuinely free and genuinely good. An Indian company, so support hours match.
- 5 GB per mailbox, which is a lot of text and not much attachment.
- **The catch:** the free plan does not allow other mail apps to connect. Mail is read in Zoho's own app or on the web — *not* in Gmail or Outlook. That is fine if she is happy with a second app, and irritating if she is not.

MY SUGGESTION

Take Google Workspace. A wedding planner lives in her inbox on a phone all day, and ₹1,800 a year against what a single wedding bills is not a real saving. Take Zoho only if she would rather not add a subscription right now — you can move to Google later, and the mail moves with you.

DONE WHEN you have picked one. Step 4 covers whichever you chose.

STEP 4

Create info@riwaaya.in YOU

If you chose Google Workspace

- ☐ Go to `workspace.google.com` and start the sign-up.
- ☐ When asked, choose “**Yes, I have one I can use**” and enter `riwaaya.in`. Do not let it sell you a new domain.
- ☐ Create the first user as **info**, which gives you `info@riwaaya.in`. Set a strong password and write it down for Bhumi.

- ☐ Google will ask you to verify you own the domain. It gives you a **TXT** record — add it at the registrar exactly as shown, then press Verify. This usually clears in minutes.
- ☐ Google then shows the MX records. Go to Step 5 and add them.

If you chose Zoho Mail

- ☐ Go to **zoho.com/mail** and pick the **Forever Free Plan**. It sits below the paid tiers and is easy to scroll past.
- ☐ Choose **“Sign up with a domain I already own”** and enter **riwaaya.in**.
- ☐ Verify the domain with the **TXT** record Zoho gives you, added at the registrar.
- ☐ Create the first mailbox as **info**.
- ☐ Zoho then shows its MX records. Go to Step 5.

ONE THING WORTH DOING WHILE YOU ARE THERE

Set up an alias, not a second mailbox, for anything else she wants — **bhumi@riwaaya.in** or **hello@riwaaya.in**. Aliases are free on both providers and deliver into the same inbox. A second *mailbox* costs money on Google and uses one of the five on Zoho.

DONE WHEN the provider says the domain is verified and the mailbox exists — even though mail will not arrive until Step 5.

Add the email DNS records YOU

MX records tell the world where to deliver mail for riwaaya.in. Until these exist, anything sent to info@riwaaya.in bounces.

COPY FROM YOUR PROVIDER'S SCREEN, NOT FROM HERE

The records below are what each provider normally gives, so you can sanity-check what you are seeing. But **Zoho hands out different servers depending on which data centre your account lands in (.in or .com),** and Google occasionally varies. Whatever the setup wizard shows you is correct; this page is only for recognising it.

Google Workspace — one record

```
MX
Name      @
Value     smtp.google.com
Priority  1
```

Zoho Mail — three records

```
MX
@ → mx.zoho.in      Priority 10
@ → mx2.zoho.in     Priority 20
@ → mx3.zoho.in     Priority 50
```

Then, for both — the two that stop your mail going to spam

These are not optional. Without them, mail from info@riwaaya.in lands in junk folders often enough to lose enquiries, and a client who never sees a reply assumes she was ignored.

SPF — says which servers may send as you

```
Type  TXT
Name  @
Value v=spf1 include:_spf.google.com ~all  (Google)
Value v=spf1 include:zoho.in ~all       (Zoho)
```

DKIM — signs each message so it cannot be forged

```
Type  TXT
Name  given by the provider, e.g. google._domainkey
Value a long key, generated in the provider's console — must be copied from there
```

DKIM is generated per domain, so there is no value I can print. In Google it is under **Apps → Google Workspace → Gmail → Authenticate email**. In Zoho it is under **Domains → DKIM**. Generate it, paste the

record at the registrar, then press Verify.

ONLY ONE SPF RECORD, EVER

If the domain already has a `TXT` record starting `v=spf1`, do not add a second one — two SPF records is an error and mail providers treat the pair as invalid. Merge them into one line instead.

DONE WHEN you can send an email from another account to `info@riwaaya.in` and it arrives. Try it from a Gmail address; delivery is usually working within fifteen minutes.

STEP 6

Tell the website its new address YOU

The site is currently built assuming a temporary address. This step is short, easy to miss, and everything about being found on Google depends on it.

- ☐ Vercel → the project → **Settings** → **Environment Variables**.
- ☐ Set `NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL` to `https://riwaaya.in` — production, and **no slash on the end**.
- ☐ **Redeploy**. Deployments → the latest one → the `⋮` menu → Redeploy.

STEP 3 OF 3 IS THE ONE PEOPLE SKIP

These values are baked in when the site is built, not read fresh each time someone visits. **Changing the variable without redeploying changes nothing at all** — the live site carries on advertising the old address, and every page keeps telling Google that the real domain is a copy of the temporary one.

DONE WHEN the new deployment reads `READY`.

STEP 7

Check that it all worked YOU

Five checks, two minutes. Together they catch the whole class of “it looks live but is still pointing at the old address” mistakes.

OPEN THIS	YOU SHOULD SEE
riwaaya.in	The website, with a padlock in the address bar
riwaaya.in/sitemap.xml	A list of pages, every one starting <code>https://riwaaya.in</code>
riwaaya.in/llms.txt	A plain summary of the studio, same real address throughout
riwaaya.in/admin	A password box. Then the panel once you sign in
The panel itself	“Your own domain” has turned green by itself

That last one is the real test. The panel does not read a setting to decide whether the domain is live — it looks at the address that actually served the page. If it says the domain is done, the domain is genuinely done.

DONE WHEN all five pass. At that point the site is properly live.

STEP 8

Google Search Console YOU

Do this the same day the domain goes live. It is how you find out whether Google can actually read the site, rather than guessing.

- ☐ Go to `search.google.com/search-console` and add `riwaaya.in` as a **Domain** property.
- ☐ Verify with the **TXT** record it gives you. You are already in the registrar from Step 2, so this is quick.
- ☐ Open **Sitemaps** and submit `sitemap.xml`.
- ☐ Come back weekly for the first two months and read the **Pages** report. Indexing problems show there first and are cheap to fix early.

DONE WHEN the sitemap reads Success and pages start appearing as indexed. Give it a week before worrying.

STEP 9

Google Business Profile BHUMI

The highest-value thing on this entire list, and the one item that genuinely needs her rather than you. For a wedding planner in a named city, the profile outranks the website itself for local searches.

- ☐ At `business.google.com`, create the profile in **her** Google account, not yours. It is her business, and moving ownership later is tedious.
- ☐ Primary category **Wedding Planner**. Secondary **Event Planner**.
- ☐ Service area: Chandigarh, Mohali, Panchkula, plus the hill destinations.
- ☐ Address, spelled exactly as the website has it — same abbreviations, same order:
`D-231, 3rd & 4th Floor, Phase 8B (Sector 91), Mohali, Punjab`
- ☐ Phone `+91 99159 09996`, website `https://riwaaya.in`, mail `info@riwaaya.in`.
- ☐ Verify. Google usually posts a postcard with a code, so allow a couple of weeks.
- ☐ Add photographs at brand quality and the wordmark as the profile image.

WHY THE WORDING HAS TO MATCH EXACTLY

Google decides whether the website, the profile and any directory listing are the same business by comparing the name, address and phone number. “3rd Floor” in one place and “Third Floor” in another is enough to make it hesitate — and a business it is unsure about does not get the local ranking. Copy and paste; do not retype.

DONE WHEN the profile is verified and searching “Riwaaya” shows the panel on the right of the results.

Every DNS record, in one table

What the registrar should hold once you are finished. Useful for checking your work, and for whoever looks at this in two years.

TYPE	NAME	VALUE	PURPOSE
A	@	76.76.21.21	Website
CNAME	www	cname.vercel-dns.com	www version
MX	@	smtp.google.com (1) or mx.zoho.in (10), mx2.zoho.in (20), mx3.zoho.in (50)	Incoming mail
TXT	@	v=spf1 include:_spf.google.com ~all or v=spf1 include:zoho.in ~all	Anti-spoofing
TXT	google._domainkey or zoho._domainkey	the long key from the provider console	Signing
TXT	@	the Search Console verification string	Search Console

OPTIONAL, WORTH ADDING A MONTH LATER

Once mail has been flowing for a few weeks, add a DMARC record — TXT on _dmarc with the value `v=DMARC1; p=none; rua=mailto:info@riwaaya.in`. It asks the world to report anyone forging mail from the domain. Start at `p=none`, which only reports and never blocks.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

The four things that actually happen

WHAT YOU SEE

WHAT IT IS

Vercel still says invalid after an hour

Almost always a leftover parking record. Go back and check there is exactly one **A** record on **@**, and that the old one is gone rather than sitting alongside the new one.

The site loads on www but not without it

The **A** record on **@** is missing or wrong. Some registrars will not accept the **@** symbol — try leaving the name field blank, or typing the full domain instead.

Mail to info@ bounces

MX records have not spread yet, or an old MX from the registrar's own mail offering is still there with a better priority. Delete anything you did not add.

Sent mail lands in spam

SPF or DKIM missing, or two SPF records fighting. Test at **mail-tester.com** — send it a message and it scores you out of ten with the reason.

To see what the world currently thinks your DNS says — which is not always what the registrar screen shows — use **dnschecker.org**. It queries from several countries at once, which tells you whether a change has spread or you are looking at a stale answer.

CHANGES TAKE TIME, AND THAT IS NORMAL

DNS updates usually appear within minutes but are allowed up to 48 hours. If something is not working after an hour, check for a mistake rather than waiting — but if the records look right, waiting genuinely is the fix.

What to send me when you are done

Once the steps above are finished, these are the things still waiting on the studio. The panel at riwaaya.in/admin tracks all of them and updates itself as each arrives.

WHAT	WHY IT MATTERS
Photographs Blocks launch	Every image on the site today is a stand-in from a free stock library. They are not Riwaaya's work and must not go public. Send them with the photographer's name and the couple's permission.
Testimonials Blocks launch	The five quotes on the site are written placeholders with invented names. Send three to five real ones, or tell me to remove the section — both are fine, publishing the current ones is not.
A portrait of Bhumi	The founder section is showing a labelled placeholder. Any well-lit photograph works; upright crops suit the space.
The office PIN code	Left deliberately blank — Phase 8B covers more than one PIN and a wrong postcode does more damage in local search than a missing one.
A Google Maps link	The contact map is accurate to about 300 metres. Open Maps, find the office, tap Share, send the link.
The six destinations, confirmed	The site describes Udaipur, Jaipur, Jodhpur, Kasauli, Rishikesh and Goa in detail. Tell me which she has actually worked and I will cut the rest.
Real venue names	The venues page names no property on purpose. Real names are what families search for — but only ones there is a genuine relationship with.
The logo file	The arch on the site is a careful rebuild from the images sent over chat. The original <code>.ai</code> or <code>.svg</code> drops straight in.

THE PANEL IS THE LIVE VERSION OF THIS LIST

Nine of these ten items are worked out from the website itself rather than ticked off by hand, so they change on their own as things arrive. If it says something is still outstanding, it genuinely is.

Riwaaya by Bhumi Sandhu · Prepared 21 August 2026 · Questions on any step, ask and I will walk through it.